

Donghwan Rho

📍 Seoul, South Korea ✉️ donghwan_rho@snu.ac.kr ☎️ +82-10-7713-6586 🌐 Website in LinkedIn 🐙 Github

Research Interests

- Implementing Language Models Under Homomorphic Encryption
- Mathematical Reasoning in Large Language Models
- Interpretability of Language Models

Education

- Ph.D. Seoul National University**, Mathematical Sciences Mar. 2021 – Present
- Advisor: [Ernest K. Ryu](#)
 - Expected Graduation: Feb. 2026
- BS Korea University**, Mathematics Education Mar. 2015 – Feb. 2021
- Graduated 1st in Class
 - (Mandatory) Military Service: May 2017 - Jan. 2019
 - Teacher's Certificate for Secondary Regular Teacher of Mathematics

Experience

- Workshop Coordinator**, SNU-KAIST ML Theory Workshop Gangneung, South Korea
Aug. 2024
- Assisted in planning the schedule, selecting the venue, and managing workshop programs.
- Teaching Practicum** Seoul, South Korea
Apr. 2020 - May 2020
- Danggok high school
- Military Service**, Auxiliary Police Seoul, South Korea
May 2017 – Jan. 2019
- Assisted in maintaining public order and security.

Publications

*: Equal Contribution

- [3] **Studying the Korean Word-Chain Game with RLVR: Mitigating Reward Conflicts via Curriculum Learning** Oct. 2025
Donghwan Rho
 In progress
[Paper](#)
- [2] **Traveling Salesman-Based Token Ordering Improves Stability in Homomorphically Encrypted Language Models** Oct. 2025
Donghwan Rho*, Sieun Seo*, Hyewon Sung, Chohong Min, Ernest K. Ryu
 Submitted
[Paper](#)
- [1] **Encryption-Friendly LLM Architecture** Oct. 2024
Donghwan Rho*, Taeseong Kim*, Minje Park, Jung Woo Kim, Hyunsik Chae, Ernest K. Ryu, Jung Hee Cheon
 International Conference on Learning Representations (ICLR) 2025
[Paper](#) [Code](#)

Talks & Presentations

- Symposium of the Research Institute of Mathematics, Seoul National University,** Nov. 2025
Talk
- Title: Implementing Efficient Language Models under Homomorphic Encryption
[Site link](#), [Blog post](#) (Thanks to [Yossi Frenkel](#)), [Slides](#)
- Korean Mathematical Society Annual Meeting,** Talk Oct. 2025
- Title: Homomorphically encrypted language models stabilized with TSP-sorted tokens
[Link](#)
- SNU-Samsung Electronics Collaboration Symposium,** Poster Presentation Aug. 2024
- Title: Encryption-Friendly LLM Architecture
- SNU-KAIST ML Theory Workshop,** Poster Presentation Aug. 2024
- Title: Encryption-Friendly LLM Architecture

Honors and Awards

- Outstanding TA,** Seoul National University [Link](#) July 2025
Introduction to Computer Programming and Artificial Intelligence for Scientists
- University Students Contest of Mathematics,** Silver Prize [Link](#) Dec. 2018
- Academic Excellence Scholarship,** Korea University Aug. 2015

Teaching

- Peer Tutoring in Basic Sciences,** Lead Teaching Assistant Mar. 2024 - Present
- Represented section TAs to ensure the smooth operation of the peer tutoring program.
 - Oversaw tutorings in Mathematics, Physics, Chemistry, Biology, and Statistics.
- Basic Calculus,** Teaching Assistant Sep. 2021 - Present
- Matched tutors and tutees for the *Basic Calculus* peer tutoring program.
 - Managed program logistics to ensure efficient operation.
- SNU Pre-College Program,** Head TA, Instructor
- Managed logistics of the mathematics program for freshman undergraduate.
 - Gave lectures.
 - Winter 2024, Winter 2023, Winter 2022
- Introduction to Computer Programming and Artificial Intelligence for Scientists,** Spring 2025
Instructor
- English Course
 - Selected as an [outstanding TA](#)
- Topics in Machine Intelligence** Fall 2024
- Topics: Continuous-depth neural networks, Diffusion Models, Large Language Models, Vision Language Models, State-space Models
 - English Course
 - Graduate Course

Mathematical algorithms II

Fall 2022

- Topics: Reinforcement Learning, Diffusion Models, Natural Language Processing
- English Course
- Graduate Course

Calculus 2 Practice, Instructor

- Fall 2021, Fall 2025

Calculus 1 Practice, Instructor

- Spring 2024, Fall 2023, Spring 2023, Spring 2022, Spring 2021

Technical Skills

Languages: Korean (Native), English (Fluent)

Programming Languages: Python, C++

Tools & Technologies: LaTeX, GitHub